

Namaste!!

Since early childhood, my beloved late principal instilled in me scientific temperament by providing constant concept learning questions.

When I was in sixth standard, I had gone to walk with my mother. There I saw dogs fighting over sanitary napkins that lay on the road side. I was intrigued by the scene .My mother stepped in to clear my ambiguity. She explained me importance of menstrual hygiene, various menstrual hygiene products& their proper disposal. So when I got my first chance to present science project in a young scientist competition; I decided to do project on menstrual hygiene and disposal of sanitary waste. Owing to the stereotypical mindset of the people, I received harsh criticism from my mentors, friends for doing project on such a bold topic about which even women do not talk .But I ignored, read the literature, did community survey, knowledge awareness camps in schools colleges and slum areas.

I provided with cash free, rash free, trash free sustainable menstrual hygiene option like menstrual cup .Finally I received warm appreciation from renowned scientist of my country.

As Aleanor Roosevelt correctly said, “do what you feel in your heart to be right-for you will be criticised anyway .You will be damned if you do and damned even if you do not do”.

As a growing child, I had to witness and experience the emotional trauma of maternal deaths during childbirth due to excessive blood loss. From my doctor parents, I came to know that, PPH (post partum haemorrhage) is the major & quickest killer of mother during childbirth all over the world and especially in developing countries.

Globally 1,40,000 women die every year due to PPH otherwise 1 mother dies every 4 minutes -ACOG practice Bulletin 2006  
It is unpredictable & every parturient woman is at risk of having PPH.

The accurate estimation of blood loss is most important key factor but unfortunately, at present there is no ideal prevalent method to measure the blood loss accurately and in real-time. It created deep impact on my tender mind. I started to find the solution for the same.

From the knowledge of menstrual cup from my previous project, I thought of remodelling it to measure the exact amount of blood loss.

It was great challenge for me to communicate with the engineering people in series of meetings for mould development and its rectification. Finally my innovation-silicone cup: PPH cup was ready after marathon efforts of almost one year.

It is implemented in the clinical practice and found to be user-friendly, life saving, economical & environmentally sustainable.

True reward and recognition comes to me when people find my innovation useful and life saving.

One day a lady along with her newborn baby came to meet me and with tears in her eyes thanked me .I realised the need of more such life saving innovations.

Today when I looked back, I feel success is no accident .it is hard work, perseverance, learning, studying, sacrifice& most of all, love of what you are doing.

I feel, if I would have stopped because of others criticism or fear of failure; I would not have been able to make such a novel innovation.

I have learned that, failure and criticism are part and parcel of life; we should never get disheartened or stop from working

hard, we should learn from our own mistakes, persue our goals with undeterring commitment. Most importantly we should not let the success go to our head.

If we keep our eyes open, be sensitive towards society and social issues and use the technology to come up with smart and sustainable solutions, we can definitely bring a sea change.